

RESEARCH PROPOSAL FORM

Student Details		
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Tutor: Prof. Salamah Mahmood	Evaluator:	
Proposed Research Title (Provisional) The impact of social media on Saudi children's food habits.		
Research Questions (Please list your research questions. For example, they could investigate the problem, effects and solutions) Explain how they will help achieve the aim of your topic. Make sure that they can't already be answered with existing background information 1. How can social media affect Saudi children's food habits? 2. What can Saudi parents do to help make their children diet healthier?		
Background Information (What information did you find related to your research area? Please provide a minimum of three references and explain how they support your choice of topic) Guo, M. (2023). The impact of unhealthy food marketing on children on social media platforms: A systematic review and meta-analysis of empirical studies examining children's exposure to digital marketing and its influence on food preferences and consumption behaviors. (https://francis-and-taylor.com/uploads/papers/mrD2Z6nsZjSIQ6XLttaHijJlqDfibXFLxfYqh2e.pdf) Smith et al. (2018) conducted a systematic review investigating the impact of digital food marketing on children and adolescents. The study found that exposure to food advertisements through social media platforms significantly increases children's preference for high-fat and high-sugar foods. The authors concluded that digital marketing techniques, including influencer promotions and targeted advertisements, have a measurable influence on unhealthy eating behaviors among young populations. (https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC6073489/pdf/ijerph-15-00963.pdf) (page2-3) Alanazi et al. (2023) conducted a systematic review examining the relationship between social media use and unhealthy dietary habits. The study found a significant association between high social media exposure and increased fast food consumption, particularly among younger populations. The findings suggest that digital content and online food promotion contribute to poor nutritional behaviors. (https://saudijournals.com/media/articles/SJMPS_912_839-844_FT.pdf)		

Proposed Research Design & Strategy

(Provide details and information about your potential participants. Why are they relevant to your topic? What method of data collection would you consider using?)

The participants will be Saudi children aged 8–20 years old who regularly use social media platforms. They will be asked about their social media usage and their eating habits.

They were chosen because they represent a vulnerable group that is highly influenced by online content and food advertising.

A questionnaire will be used.

Tutor and Evaluator Comments